The decision to include the Soviet Union in the alliance against Nazism and Fascism also meant that Western Allies gradually came to acknowledge as legitimate various Communist-led resistance movements in Central and Eastern Europe, who yearned for recognition, hoping that this would in time lead to their legitimacy as a future government after liberation. The Western allies had no interest in discerning complex local situations nor time to spend on them. There is even some evidence to suggest that, in these contacts with local Communist resistance movements, the British at least made use of their own left-leaning army officers, who relayed back home a rosy picture of these movements, one that Western governments could tolerate.[71]

In acting as he did, Roosevelt was ignoring the advice of military observers in Moscow, mistakenly thinking that Russia would democratise itself soon.[72] But it was Churchill who, on a visit to Moscow in October 1944, proposed spheres of influence in Eastern Europe to Stalin on a piece of paper. This is how Churchill describes the meeting in his own memoirs:

At ten o'clock that night we held our first important meeting in the Kremlin… The moment was apt for business, so I said, 'Let us settle about our affairs in the Balkans. Your armies are in Rumania and Bulgaria. We have interests, missions, and agents there. Don't let us get at cross-purposes in small ways. So far as Britain and Russia are concerned, how would it do for you to have ninety per cent predominance in Rumania, for us to have ninety per cent of the say in Greece, and go fifty-fifty about Yugoslavia?' While this was being translated I wrote out on a half-sheet of paper:

Rumania
Russia 90%
The others 10%
Greece
Great Britain (in accord with USA) 90%
Russia (10%)
Yugoslavia 50–50%
Hungary 50–50%
Bulgaria
Russia 75%
The others 25%

I pushed this across to Stalin, who had by then heard the translation.